A*STAR Technology Support for Manufacturers (T-Up, ARTC, COIs, OTR) — SMF Advisory Note

Internal advisory note for SMF member-facing officers. Not legal or financial advice.

> ***ACCURACY WARNING FOR THIS NOTE.*** *During compilation,* ***a-star.edu.sg and its subdomains (artc., simtech.) could not be accessed****. Everything below is therefore sourced from **Enterprise Singapore's site cross-referencing A*STAR entities**, not from A\STAR's own pages. The* ***Operation & Technology Roadmapping (OTR)*** *and* ***Tech Access*** *programmes could not be confirmed to still exist. Officers must check a-star.edu.sg directly before advising a member on any A\STAR programme.*

Overview

A*STAR is Singapore's lead public-sector R&D agency and works with manufacturing SMEs through several routes: secondment of scientists and engineers into companies (T-Up), shared research and demonstration facilities (ARTC, SIMTech, Centres of Innovation), and technology roadmapping advisory. For SMF members,* ASTAR engagement is usually the *precursor* to an EnterpriseSG grant — the technical scoping happens with A*STAR, and the implementation is then funded through EDG or PSG.

What It Funds

T-Up — Technology for Enterprise Capability Upgrading — CONFIRMED LIVE *(verified via EnterpriseSG)*

What it is: *"Administered by A*\STAR and AI Singapore (AISG)." *T-Up seconds research scientists, engineers and technical experts from A*STAR research institutes and Institutes of Higher Learning into a company **for up to two years**, so the company can build in-house technical capability rather than buying a one-off consultancy report.

Funding support:

- **Up to 70% of allowable costs for an SME or startup**
- **Up to 30% for a large local enterprise (LLE)**
- **Both capped at S$250,000 per project**
- Overseas costs (living allowance, airfare) are fundable.

Eligibility (all four must be met):

- Registered or incorporated in Singapore
- **At least 30% local equity** (Singaporean/PR, by ultimate individual ownership)
- Financially able to finance and complete the project
- **Group Annual Sales Turnover ≤ S$100 million OR Group employment ≤ 200 employees**

Listed project areas include manufacturing automation & technology, materials research & engineering, microelectronics, and AI/machine learning — all directly relevant to SMF's membership.

How to apply: "Register interest" via the Microsoft Forms link on the EnterpriseSG page. AI projects should be directed to `AISG_TUP@aisingapore.org`.

Source: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/innovate-with-us/innovation-talent/technology-for-enterprise-capability-upgrading

Centres of Innovation (COIs) — CONFIRMED LIVE *(verified via EnterpriseSG)*

COIs give SMEs access to **shared R&D facilities, technical expertise, training and coaching**. The relevant entry in EnterpriseSG's COI Directory for manufacturers is the **Advanced Manufacturing Centre of Innovation (AMCOI)** — *"In collaboration with Nanyang Polytechnic, Ngee Ann Polytechnic, Singapore Polytechnic, A*\STAR

Singapore Institute of Manufacturing Technology and Temasek Polytechnic."* Its scope covers robotics and autonomous technology, data science and analytics, AI, and additive manufacturing. SIMTech contact published in the directory: `cttan@simtech.a-star.edu.sg`.

Tax benefit: *"Qualifying innovation expenditure through selected COIs can receive 400% tax deductions up to an expenditure cap"* under the **Enterprise Innovation Scheme** (Budget 2023). **TO VERIFY: the current expenditure cap and whether the Enterprise Innovation Scheme has been extended beyond its original window.**

Naming inconsistency to flag: EnterpriseSG's **Precision Engineering industry page** still separately lists a **"Precision Engineering Centre of Innovation (PE COI)"** (*"Leverage SIMTech's manufacturing technologies…"*), plus the **SIMTech Innovation Factory (IF)** and **IAF-ICP**, while the **COI Directory has no PE COI entry** and instead lists AMCOI. PE COI appears to have been folded into or rebranded as AMCOI, but the industry page has not been updated. **TO VERIFY which is authoritative before referring a member.**

Sources: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/innovate-with-us/innovation-capabilities/centres-of-innovation and its COI Directory sub-page; https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/industries/precision-engineering

Link to EDG: EnterpriseSG's EDG page lists Centres of Innovation as a resource under Product Development, but **does not state that COI engagement is itself EDG-fundable. TO VERIFY** before telling a member the COI fee can be claimed under EDG.

A*STAR ARTC (Advanced Remanufacturing and Technology Centre) — EXISTENCE CONFIRMED ONLY BY THIRD-PARTY REFERENCE

ARTC is still named on EnterpriseSG's live 2026 Precision Engineering page, in the **"Model Digital Factories"** programme card: *"Test and co-develop digital solutions through model digital factories at A*\STAR's SIMTech and ARTC."* The detail page returns an empty body.

- **Membership model, tiers and fees: TO VERIFY — not found on any official page reachable during compilation.**
- **Location, focus areas, and what SMEs specifically receive: TO VERIFY.**
- Do not quote an ARTC membership fee to a member. Direct them to A*STAR.

Operation & Technology Roadmapping (OTR) — COULD NOT BE CONFIRMED

TO VERIFY — no trace of OTR was found on any official page reachable during compilation. A full-text search of EnterpriseSG's sitemap returned **zero matches for "roadmap"**. The following are all unverified: who runs it (A*STAR / SIMTech / EnterpriseSG), what a participating company receives, eligibility, cost or subsidy to the company, the application route, and **whether it is still running in 2026**.

OTR has historically been associated with A*STAR SIMTech as a structured workshop-based methodology for aligning a company's business objectives with a technology investment plan, and is often cited as a precursor to an EDG project. ***That historical description must not be presented as current fact in a member-facing answer.*** *Confirm with A*STAR before advising.

A*STAR Tech Access Initiative — COULD NOT BE CONFIRMED

TO VERIFY — no trace found on any reachable official page. Status (live or closed), costs and eligibility all unknown. Historically this provided SMEs with access to advanced manufacturing equipment on a pay-per-use basis with trained operator support. **Do not assert it still exists.**

GET-Up (Growing Enterprises through Technology Upgrade) — BRAND NOT CONFIRMED

TO VERIFY. The umbrella "GET-Up" brand does not appear on EnterpriseSG. Only its **T-Up** component is confirmed, and it is presented standalone. Do not use the GET-Up name with a member without checking.

2025/2026 A*STAR restructuring — NO EVIDENCE EITHER WAY

TO VERIFY. EnterpriseSG's live 2026 pages still name **"A*STAR's SIMTech" **and** "ARTC"** as distinct entities and still reference "A*STAR Singapore Institute of Manufacturing Technology". There is **no mention of any merged "A*STAR Advanced Manufacturing" entity** on any reachable page. This is weak evidence against a

completed merger, but EnterpriseSG's pages are demonstrably stale in places (see the PE COI / AMCOI contradiction above), so it is not conclusive.

Eligibility Summary

Programme	Local equity	Size test	Status
T-Up	≥30%	≤S$100m group turnover **OR** ≤200 employees	**LIVE**
COI / AMCOI	Not stated on COI pages — **TO VERIFY**	Not stated — **TO VERIFY**	**LIVE**
ARTC	**TO VERIFY**	**TO VERIFY**	Existence confirmed; terms unknown
OTR	**TO VERIFY**	**TO VERIFY**	**Unconfirmed — may or may not still run**
Tech Access	**TO VERIFY**	**TO VERIFY**	**Unconfirmed**

For comparison, EDG (which typically funds the implementation phase that follows A*STAR scoping) requires Singapore registration and ≥30% local shareholding, funds **up to 50% for SMEs / up to 30% for non-SMEs**, runs projects typically **12–18 months**, and is applied for on the Business Grants Portal with Corppass; management consultancy components require an **SAC-accredited TR 43 or SS 680** certified consultant.

Common Pitfalls

- **Treating A*STAR engagement as a grant.** T-Up is a co-funded secondment; COIs are facility and expertise access; ARTC is a research consortium. Only T-Up has a published cash support rate.
- **Assuming the S$250,000 T-Up cap is per company.** It is **per project**.
- **Assuming a two-year secondment is automatically approved.** "Up to two years" is a ceiling.
- **Recommending OTR or Tech Access as live programmes.** Neither could be confirmed. Phrase these as "worth checking with A*STAR" rather than as available options.
- **Sending a member to "PE COI".** It may no longer exist under that name; AMCOI is the entry in the current COI Directory.
- **Assuming COI fees are EDG-claimable.** Not confirmed.

Source & Last Verified

- T-Up: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/innovate-with-us/innovation-talent/technology-for-enterprise-capability-upgrading
- COIs: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/grow-your-business/innovate-with-us/innovation-capabilities/centres-of-innovation (and COI Directory sub-page)
- Precision Engineering industry page: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/industries/precision-engineering
- EDG FAQ: https://www.enterprisesg.gov.sg/resources/all-faqs/enterprise-development-grant
- **Could not be accessed:** https://www.a-star.edu.sg/ (all paths, including /tech-access and /artc), https://artc.a-star.edu.sg/, mti.gov.sg
- **Last verified: 26 July 2026.**